

Checklist:

Getting Things Done Checklist

Set direction

- ☐ Define a concrete vision with a clear, measurable outcome.
- ☐ Make sure the vision is easy to repeat and hard to misinterpret.
- ☐ Test whether different people describe the goal the same way.
- ☐ Write a believable plan for how the team will get there.

Build the plan

- ☐ Base the plan on your team's real strengths and constraints.
- ☐ Choose the few priorities that matter most.
- ☐ Cut or defer lower-value work.
- ☐ Break big goals into smaller milestones.
- ☐ Add buffer for delays, surprises, and changing conditions.

Organize execution

- ☐ Define who owns each decision, task, and follow-up.
- ☐ Clarify what must be done, by whom, and by when.
- ☐ Prioritize work from most important to least important.
- ☐ Make decisions quickly when enough information is available.
- ☐ Once a decision is made, commit and move forward.
- ☐ Revisit plans promptly when important new information becomes available.

Balance time horizons

- ☐ Define the long-term vision first, then work backward.
- ☐ Connect short-term work to long-term goals.
- ☐ Keep a portfolio of work:
 - ☐ short-term improvements
 - ☐ medium-term projects
 - ☐ longer-term bets
- ☐ Avoid over-optimizing for only the immediate term.

- ☐ Avoid locking into long-term plans that no longer fit reality.

Improve process

- ☐ Run regular debriefs / retrospectives.
- ☐ Focus debriefs on learning, not blame.
- ☐ Capture lessons and share them with others.
- ☐ Turn repeated work into playbooks or checklists.
- ☐ Update processes as the team learns.

Signs the team is executing well

- ☐ Top priorities get the most time and attention.
- ☐ There is a trusted process for making decisions.
- ☐ The team moves quickly, especially on reversible decisions.
- ☐ People commit after decisions, even if they disagreed earlier.
- ☐ New information leads to fast reassessment.
- ☐ Every task has a clear owner and deadline.
- ☐ The team keeps learning and gets stronger after mistakes.